

COT DUAL-SOURCE BREAKDOWN

Week Ending June 16, 2026 | Analysis Date: June 23, 2026

Source 1: CFTC TFF -- Leveraged Funds (speculative hedge funds/CTAs) and Asset Managers (institutional); Disaggregated Managed Money for commodities. **Source 2:** Tradingster Legacy Non-Commercial (broader speculator group = Lev Funds + Asset Mgr combined).

COT Index: Larry Williams percentile over full dataset -- Bullish >=60 | Bearish <=40 | Neutral 40-60. **Next CFTC release:** Jun 27 (positions as of Jun 24).

Source 1 -- CFTC Lev Fund / Managed Money (net contracts)

SYM	May-19	May-26	Jun-02	Jun-09	Jun-16	IDX	BIAS	LEV SIG	AM SIG
EUR	16317	7296	12027	-17388	-8926	12	Bearish	flip-UP	closing
GBP	31369	28829	27353	22312	16836	34	Bearish	pressing	adding
JPY	-64945	-70508	-88063	-99844	-96772	2	Bearish	flip-UP	closing
NZD	-15336	-13670	-27725	-22254	-22187	16	Bearish	--	--
USD	-11716	-12530	-11112	-13656	-1870	59	Neutral	flip-UP	--
ES	-402312	-459415	-503509	-459690	-523882	0	Bearish	flip-DN	--
NQ	-45371	-51679	-53650	-34306	-28154	47	Neutral	--	closing
US30	-14578	-16197	-13898	-9172	-9898	48	Neutral	flip-DN	adding
BTC	-8961	-8634	-6558	-5995	-6607	96	Bullish	flip-DN	adding
GOLD	94388	96931	111341	103660	112918	20	Bearish	flip-UP	--
SILVER	11761	10244	10433	9794	12070	17	Bearish	flip-UP	--
CRUDE	138774	115762	124259	123207	117885	71	Bullish	--	--
VIX	-51904	-49336	-33033	-35290	-13295	19	Bearish	flip-DN	--

Source 2 -- Tradingster Non-Commercial (Lev Fund + Asset Mgr combined, broader spec group)

SYM	May-19	May-26	Jun-02	Jun-09	Jun-16	IDX	BIAS	ALIGNMENT
EUR	33513	29426	48866	13932	34353	49	Neutral	DIVERGE
GBP	-64307	-61398	-52218	-64213	-71585	15	Bearish	CONFIRMED
JPY	-93905	-114667	-129567	-145818	-150132	9	Bearish	CONFIRMED
NZD	-40613	-34179	-28246	-31571	-45161	13	Bearish	CONFIRMED
USD	-479	850	3758	1384	13197	40	Bearish	DIVERGE
ES	-134906	-159316	-214309	-194554	-180143	44	Neutral	DIVERGE
NQ	-1420	-6085	-14949	-1349	-8908	42	Neutral	NEUTRAL
US30	-10765	-9324	-5629	-2539	4339	49	Neutral	NEUTRAL
BTC	2112	2282	2458	3018	3475	100	Bullish	CONFIRMED
GOLD	159833	154260	176020	173837	180220	56	Neutral	DIVERGE
SILVER	24671	22223	23926	22214	24544	40	Bearish	CONFIRMED
CRUDE	172580	160998	155874	130301	124483	12	Bearish	DIVERGE
VIX	-55769	-54484	-69952	-74420	-66739	51	Neutral	DIVERGE

Instrument-by-Instrument Analysis

-- FOREX --

EUR	S1: Bearish IDX 12	S2: Neutral IDX 49	DIVERGE
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4-Week Trend: Lev Funds flipped from +16k long (May 19) to -8.9k short (Jun 16) -- a 25k swing in 4 weeks. Asset Managers closing longs. NonComm stayed net long (+34.4k Jun 16), bouncing from a dip to +13.9k on Jun 9.

Analysis: CTAs/hedge funds turned short while the broader institutional spec group remains net long. EUR/USD has a ceiling (NonComm longs resist downside) but sellers on every rally while lev funds have conviction.

This week (Jun 23):

Bearish lean. Fresh lev fund short entry. Sell rallies. Watch for NonComm to follow into short for full confirmation.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bearish (unconfirmed). If NonComm crosses net short, bias strengthens significantly.

GBP

S1: Bearish IDX 34

S2: Bearish IDX 15

CONFIRMED

4-Week Trend: S1 steadily declining 31.4k -> 16.8k longs, 'pressing' signal (selling accelerating vs 4-wk avg). S2 already deep net short -71.6k, worsening from -52k four weeks ago.

Analysis: Unambiguous dual-source confirmation. Lev Funds not just holding short -- adding with conviction. AM adding longs may moderate pace but does not change the structural direction.

This week (Jun 23):

Bearish. GBP/USD offer on rallies. Strong institutional selling pressure from both sources.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bearish continuation expected. Cleanest confirmed bearish setup in the forex space.

JPY

S1: Bearish IDX 2

S2: Bearish IDX 9

CONFIRMED

4-Week Trend: S1 Lev Funds at -96.8k (IDX 2 = near all-time extreme short). S2 NonComm even deeper at -150.1k and worsening every week (was -93.9k four weeks ago). S1 shows 'flip-UP' -- short covering started.

Analysis: IDX=2 means speculators are at the 2nd percentile of net JPY long positioning -- near the most extreme bearish reading in history. The flip-UP short-covering in S1 is an early warning of crowd exhaustion. Bearish JPY = bullish USD/JPY, but the trade is dangerously crowded.

This week (Jun 23):

USD/JPY near-term support from persistent shorts but short-covering risk is growing. Avoid new JPY short entries at these extremes.

Next week (Jun 30):

HIGH ALERT for JPY squeeze. If Jun 24 CFTC shows accelerating short covering, USD/JPY could reverse sharply.

NZD

S1: Bearish IDX 16

S2: Bearish IDX 13

CONFIRMED

4-Week Trend: S1 stable at -22.2k shorts. S2 surged from -28.2k to -45.2k in the last week alone -- shorts being added aggressively. Both at very low IDX readings (16 and 13).

Analysis: Clean confirmation with no momentum shift signal. Steady pressure from both sources. No lev signal means no imminent reversal catalyst identified.

This week (Jun 23):

Bearish. NZD/USD likely to stay under pressure.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bearish. Both sources aligned and deteriorating.

USD

S1: Neutral IDX 59

S2: Bearish IDX 40

DIVERGE

4-Week Trend: Most dramatic single-week shift in the dataset. S1 Lev Funds: -13.7k to -1.9k in ONE week (near-full short cover, +11.8k). S2 NonComm: -479 to +13.2k net long (flipped positive). DIVERGE on IDX labels (59 vs 40) but direction of change is identical.

Analysis: Both sources converging bullish. The DIVERGE is purely a percentile-label artifact -- S1 at 59 is just below Bullish (60) threshold. NonComm just flipped net long. This is a meaningfully bullish medium-term setup.

This week (Jun 23):

USD bullish lean. DXY likely supported. The lev fund flip is a strong medium-term positioning signal.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bullish developing. If S1 IDX exceeds 60 and NonComm net long grows, this becomes CONFIRMED Bullish.

-- INDICES --

ES

S1: Bearish IDX 0

S2: Neutral IDX 44

DIVERGE

4-Week Trend: S1 Lev Funds at -523.9k contracts -- IDX=0, most extreme short in full dataset history. Added more shorts last week (flip-DN). S2 NonComm recovering: -214.3k to -180.1k in past two weeks -- NonComm is COVERING.

Analysis: Lev funds (CTAs/quant funds) are at a record extreme short while the broader NonComm group is buying. This is the hallmark of a potential short squeeze. IDX=0 is a major contrarian warning -- the most one-sided institutional short positioning ever recorded.

This week (Jun 23):

Near-term bearish momentum from lev funds, but any positive catalyst risks a violent short squeeze. Do NOT add to ES shorts at IDX=0.

Next week (Jun 30):

Extreme squeeze risk. If NonComm continues covering and lev funds hold, the coil gets tighter. Watch for any trigger.

NQ

S1: Neutral IDX 47

S2: Neutral IDX 42

NEUTRAL

4-Week Trend: S1 net shorts improved from -53.7k (Jun 2 peak) to -28.2k. No lev signal (weekly change within normal range). AM closing longs is a mild negative.

Analysis: Both sources neutral. NQ lev fund shorts have been improving for 4 weeks but no strong directional signal yet. AM closing longs could be a leading indicator.

This week (Jun 23):

Neutral. No clear COT directional edge.

Next week (Jun 30):

Neutral with slight bearish lean from AM closing longs.

US30

S1: Neutral IDX 48

S2: Neutral IDX 49

NEUTRAL

4-Week Trend: S2 NonComm turned net LONG for the first time in the 4-week window: -2.5k to +4.3k. S1 Lev Funds flip-DN (adding shorts again). AM adding longs.

Analysis: NonComm turned long while lev funds simultaneously turned more short. If NonComm net long grows and lev funds stay short, this is a classic setup for a lev fund squeeze on the upside.

This week (Jun 23):

Neutral, slight bullish lean from NonComm net long flip.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bullish lean developing if NonComm net long grows.

BTC

S1: Bullish IDX 96

S2: Bullish IDX 100

CONFIRMED

4-Week Trend: S1 IDX=96, S2 IDX=100 -- both at near-maximum historical bullish territory. NonComm net growing weekly: +2.1k to +3.5k, steady accumulation. AM adding longs. The S1 'flip-DN' is minor (small short add last week).

Analysis: Strongest dual-source confirmation in the dataset. Institutional accumulation (AM) alongside extreme NonComm long positioning. At IDX=100, crowd is fully positioned -- any disappointment hits hard but trend remains structurally intact.

This week (Jun 23):

Bullish. COT strongly supports continued BTC upside.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bullish. Watch for overbought exhaustion at IDX=100.

-- COMMODITIES --

GOLD

S1: Bearish IDX 20

S2: Neutral IDX 56

DIVERGE

4-Week Trend: Managed Money net long 112.9k at IDX=20 (20th percentile of history -- relatively low despite large absolute size). NonComm 180.2k at IDX=56 (neutral). S1 flip-UP: managed money added longs after Jun 9 dip.

Analysis: Both are still net long gold in absolute terms -- the divergence is in percentile terms, not direction. Managed money is underweight vs historical positioning. The add-back (flip-UP) in S1 is a supportive near-term signal.

This week (Jun 23):

Neutral to slightly bullish. Managed money add-back is supportive.

Next week (Jun 30):

Neutral. If managed money IDX rises toward 40, DIVERGE may resolve to NEUTRAL.

SILVER**S1: Bearish IDX 17****S2: Bearish IDX 40****CONFIRMED**

4-Week Trend: S1: 12.1k net long at IDX=17. Bounced from 5-week low of 9.8k. S2: 24.5k net long at IDX=40. S1 flip-UP: managed money added last week.

Analysis: Both at low historical percentiles despite being net long in absolute terms. Silver is underperforming gold in the COT landscape. The flip-UP gives a near-term bounce signal but does not change the medium-term picture.

This week (Jun 23):

Bearish bias from low percentile readings. Near-term bounce possible from S1 flip.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bearish continuation. Watch for S1 flip-UP to sustain or reverse.

CRUDE**S1: Bullish IDX 71****S2: Bearish IDX 12****DIVERGE**

4-Week Trend: Managed Money IDX=71 (bullish, ~118k net longs). But NonComm collapsed from 172.6k to 124.5k in 4 weeks -- a 48k contract (28%) liquidation. NonComm IDX=12, near historically bearish territory.

Analysis: Most extreme directional divergence in the dataset. NonComm aggressively liquidating while managed money holds firm. NonComm typically leads managed money at structural turning points -- this is a significant distribution signal.

This week (Jun 23):

Bearish lean. The NonComm liquidation is the dominant signal for directional change.

Next week (Jun 30):

Bearish. If NonComm continues liquidating and managed money begins to follow, downside case strengthens considerably.

-- VOLATILITY (VIX) --

VIX**S1: Bearish IDX 19****S2: Neutral IDX 51****DIVERGE**

4-Week Trend: Lev Funds covered massive VIX short positions: -51.9k to -13.3k in 4 weeks (buying VIX = expecting volatility = bearish equities). After inversion IDX=19. NonComm still net short VIX (-66.7k) at inverted IDX=51 (neutral).

Analysis: Lev funds buying VIX protection is a bearish equity signal. The 'flip-DN' post-inversion confirms that short-covering of VIX shorts is accelerating -- managers are hedging equity exposure. NonComm is not following yet.

This week (Jun 23):

Mild bearish equity signal. Lev funds are actively hedging downside risk.

Next week (Jun 30):

If NonComm reduces VIX shorts too, that would confirm broad equity fear is increasing.

Bias Summary -- Week of Jun 23 -> Jun 30, 2026

SYM	S1 IDX	S2 IDX	ALIGNMENT	THIS WEEK (Jun 23)	NEXT WEEK (Jun 30)
EUR	12	49	DIVERGE	Bearish	Bearish (unconfirmed)
GBP	34	15	CONFIRMED	Bearish	Bearish
JPY	2	9	CONFIRMED	Bearish / caution	Reversal risk HIGH
NZD	16	13	CONFIRMED	Bearish	Bearish
USD	59	40	DIVERGE	Neutral -> Bullish	Bullish developing
ES	0	44	DIVERGE	Bear / squeeze risk	Extreme caution
NQ	47	42	NEUTRAL	Neutral	Neutral
US30	48	49	NEUTRAL	Neutral	Slight bull lean
BTC	96	100	CONFIRMED	Bullish	Bullish
GOLD	20	56	DIVERGE	Neutral	Neutral
SILVER	17	40	CONFIRMED	Bearish	Bearish
CRUDE	71	12	DIVERGE	Bearish lean	Bearish
VIX	19	51	DIVERGE	Bear (equities)	Bear (equities)

Key themes this week: (1) JPY at near-all-time extreme short (IDX=2) -- highest squeeze risk in the dataset. (2) ES Lev Funds at IDX=0 (record short) while NonComm covers -- short squeeze coil very tight. (3) USD positioning flipped dramatically in one week --

bullish developing. (4) BTC fully confirmed bullish from both sources (IDX=96/100). (5) Crude NonComm liquidating 48k contracts in 4 weeks -- bearish lead signal. (6) GBP and NZD are the cleanest confirmed bearish setups in the forex space.

Report generated: June 23, 2026 | CFTC data: positions as of Jun 16 (released Jun 20) | Next CFTC release: Jun 27 (Jun 24 positions)